

NITHYASRI S R

About the Company

Bank of America(BoA) is a multinational financial institution offering wide range of banking and financial services to individuals, businesses, and corporations. It is renowned for its consumer banking, wealth management through investment banking, and global markets operations. The bank is recognized for its innovation in digital banking and committed to sustainability and community development, it actively promotes affordable housing, financial literacy, and renewable energy initiatives. With a strong global presence and focus on diversity, it remains a key player in the global financial landscape.

About the role

The freshers from our college are initially recruited for the role of GET (Graduate Engineering Trainee) but the campus role at BoA offers opportunities across diverse areas.

1. Development: Building advanced FinTech solutions for banking, trading, and risk using technologies like AI, ML, and cloud, focusing on areas like algorithmic trading, anti-money laundering, and digital banking.

2. Testing: Ensuring product quality through functional and technical testing, risk assessment, and performance optimization using tools like Selenium and JIRA.

3. Risk Management: Entry-level analysis in cloud governance, cybersecurity, and operational risk to enhance BoA's control environment.

4. Infrastructure Operations: Software development to meet both functional and non-functional business needs, focusing on DevOps, testing, and automated release.

5. Production Support: Event management, incident handling, and maintaining high availability in network and infrastructure operations.

6. Cybersecurity: Safeguarding systems against cyber threats with technologies like SIEM, Splunk, and identity management tools.

7. Identity & Access Management (IAM): Controlling access and managing compliance across various tech environments, ensuring security and governance.

8. Core Security: Monitoring for security incidents, vulnerability assessments, and ethical hacking to protect BoA's digital assets.

Preparation Strategy

- ✓ I started my preparation in my 6th semester leave (2 months).
- ✓ Started with basics of DSA concepts (Arrays, Strings, LinkedList, Stack Queue, Recursion) and then advanced concepts (Binary Search, Trees, Graphs, DP)
- ✓ DBMS and OOPs concept are important, side by side I covered that too.
- ✓ Computer Networks and Operating System questions depends on the company, so I just learnt only basics of both.
- ✓ System design is very important. (Try practicing project system design)

Placement Drive Experience

1. Online Video Assessment

This assessment is a video interview where the questions will be on left side.

- ✓ Tell me about yourself and how my qualifications & experience will relate to job role.
- ✓ I was asked to solve 2 coding questions.
 - 1. Find intersection (string input)
 - 2. Find duplicatesWe have to explain approach of both questions.
- ✓ Another approach we thought to solve the coding questions and why we used this approach

The video assessment will be for 90 minutes.

2. Interview Round 1

I was asked to go first in my panel. The interviewer took 5 minutes to go through my resume. He asked top to bottom from my resume.

- ✓ He introduced himself first and asked to introduce myself.
- ✓ As I completed my internship in Amazon, he asked me to explain my internship project first (Just an overview, not in depth).
- ✓ And then projects, I have included 3 projects in my resume. He asked about the technologies and database used.

- ✓ As I have done project named online book store, he asked to explain what are the difference between my project and amazon book store?

I was asked to explain all 3 projects completely.

Then he came to skills part in my resume. I have mentioned C++, java, python languages.

- ✓ Difference between C ++, python, java
- ✓ I have to rate my skills for all programming languages (out of 10).
- ✓ Generate random number between 1 to N.
- ✓ As I have done blood donation application where I used firebase to store donor and recipient details. He asked me about the details stored in donor and recipients.
- ✓ By using donor table, I was asked to update blood group of person where name = "xxxx" (by using SQL). If there are multiple person of same name, what will be the condition? I said I will include name and userId(which is unique)
- ✓ What are joins and different types of joins with example.
- ✓ Asked me to write self-join query and explain it
- ✓ What are DML,DDL,DCL?
- ✓ Difference between inheritance and polymorphism.

And then he came to roles and responsibilities part in resume.

- ✓ What are all the things I did in that role?
- ✓ How is my campus life?
- ✓ What happens in college culturals? Like this type of questions
- ✓ What do you know about Bank of America?
- ✓ Why do you want to join BoA?
- ✓ Where do you want to see yourself in next 5 years?
- ✓ Any questions for them?

That's the end of my interview round 1. It took nearly 45 minutes, whereas some of my friends interview was only for 20 to 30 minutes.

I came out and within five minutes, I was asked to go to another panel for my second round

3. Interview Round 2

- ✓ Tell me about yourself
- ✓ Starts with my internship projects. She was asked me to explain complete project, What are the algorithms used? How I overcame difficulties in my project ? I used

git commands in my project, she asked nearly 15 to 20 git commands and how it works?

- ✓ How did you test whether your project is working fine? And ensures it does not affect other. I have done testing in internship project, so I am able to explain well about the testing process.
- ✓ If some tests were failed, how do you know the reason for failure? How do you rectify it?

And then she came to my projects

- ✓ I was asked to explain blood donation application completely
 - About frontend and backend
 - How do you connect frontend with backend
 - How do you use firebase in your project, how it works
 - Asked me to write API code
 - About User Interface
 - System design of project
 - What will you do if multiple requests come at a time, which request would you prioritize first and why?
- ✓ In IoT project, how hardware is connected with software?
- ✓ What is the sensor range?
- ✓ Asked me to write code for removing duplicates (Given string input like {"animal","horse","tiger","monkey"})
- ✓ Define class and object in OOPs?
- ✓ Define encapsulation, polymorphism, abstraction, inheritance with example
- ✓ Difference between overriding and overloading
- ✓ Write query to automatically assign value to each row by increment of 1000 (like 1000,2000,3000,..)
- ✓ Add unique key and primary key in SQL query
- ✓ Add two columns as single primary key
- ✓ Difference between unique key and primary key
- ✓ What is normalization and purpose of normalisation
- ✓ What is your strength and weakness?
- ✓ Why should we hire you?
- ✓ Where do you want to see yourself in next five years?
- ✓ Any questions?

At last I asked about my feedback, she said I did very well and my communication was excellent.

That's the end of my interview round 2.

Tips and Tricks

- ✓ Solve DSA problems consistently
- ✓ Starts with basics and go to advance concepts
- ✓ Side by side, start preparing OOPs, CN , OS DBMS concepts
- ✓ Learn about system design
- ✓ Before going to the interview, refer previously asked interview questions of the company so that you can get an idea of it.

Materials

- ✓ DSA – Take U Forward playlist (Strivers A-Z sheet and Strivers SDE sheet)
- ✓ OOPs – Jenny’s lecture
- ✓ Computer Networks , Operating System – Interviewbit questions
- ✓ DBMS – Jenny’s Lecture & most asked top 50 SQL queries (google it)

All the best!!!